

How I'd Start a 1-Person Business With AI (In 30 Days) EP 325

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Executive Summary

Brandon Carter, 27-year fitness veteran and online business coach who claims \$20M+ earned online, lays out a three-phase AI-assisted blueprint — ideation, testimonial harvest, and marketing/automation — for launching a profitable one-person service business in 30 days.

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The 5 Habits Secretly Ruining Your Physique [9:14](#)

- **Habit 1 — Weekend calorie blowouts erasing the week's deficit**
 - Being in a 1,000-calorie deficit Mon–Fri = 5,000-calorie deficit banked
 - One Saturday night out (alcohol, big restaurant meal) + Sunday football snacks can wipe it all out
 - Analogy: depositing \$200 all week, then withdrawing \$1,000 on Saturday — you wouldn't wonder why you're broke
 - "Mediocre mantras" — phrases like "one won't hurt" or "I can take the day off" signal permission for inconsistency
 - People who are mediocre all do the same thing; exceptional physiques require exceptional consistency
 - Once you accept inconsistency, it becomes the norm — vacations, business trips, tragedies all become excuses
 - Brandon's approach: no cheat days, no cheat meals
 - When you repeatedly abstain, cravings disappear — it takes *less* discipline over time
 - When he did Sunday cheat days, cravings returned Monday–Tuesday every week, requiring constant willpower resets
 - Fix: pre-log the night before — plan exactly what you'll eat, even at parties/Super Bowl events
 - Example: his girlfriend planned her full day's calories to have room for two drinks at a night out
- **Habit 2 — Using cardio to "pay back" a bad diet [22:00](#)**
 - "Guilt cardio" = confession booth mentality: overeat → punish with extra treadmill → repeat next week
 - The math doesn't work: burning off 500 extra calories requires running ~5 miles
 - You can't out-train a bad diet, but you *can* out-diet bad training
- **Habit 3 — Ego lifting / poor form [23:39](#)**
 - Brandon tore his bicep attempting a human flag at a Vegas fitness expo after bulking from 180 to 200 lbs
 - Calls form-related injuries "FTDs" (form transmitted diseases)
 - Common violations:
 - Bicep curls with swinging elbows and thrusting hips — turns it into a full-body movement
 - Bench press with hips off the bench — accidentally converts to a decline press, recruiting different muscles
 - The fix: lift to "performance failure" — the moment you can't maintain perfect form, the weight is too heavy
 - Solution: drop the weight and do a drop set rather than cheat reps
 - Drop sets achieve the same stimulus without injury risk

- **Habit 4 — Eating "healthy" but not tracking calories** [29:19](#)
 - "I eat healthy" is meaningless without tracking — like a student saying "I go to school" when asked their GPA
 - Healthy foods (nuts, peanut butter, avocado, olive oil, cheese, keto snacks) can still exceed your calorie budget
 - Eating organic or avoiding seed oils doesn't matter if calories in > calories out
 - **Duke University study:** participants who only tracked calories (no diet or workout plan) lost an average of 5 lbs of fat in 12 weeks — just from awareness
 - Eating just 200 calories over maintenance every day = 20 lbs of fat gained in a year
 - 200 calories = a handful of nuts, 3 eggs, or ranch dressing on a big salad
 - Brandon's tracking method: uses Claude AI with a custom prompt
 - Takes a photo of food or label → Claude estimates macros
 - At end of day, says "end of day" → gets a full daily total
 - Syncs with Apple Health + Oura Ring to estimate calories burned and determine if he was in a deficit or surplus
 - FDA allows food labels to be off by 20% — another reason to track carefully
- **Habit 5 — High-intensity cardio hampering recovery** [35:19](#)
 - HIIT and sprinting are hard on the central nervous system — impairs your ability to lift heavy
 - When Brandon stopped HIIT, his muscles got bigger because CNS was less fatigued
 - High-intensity cardio also raises ghrelin/leptin (hunger hormones), causing compensatory eating
 - Low-intensity cardio (walking) does NOT have this effect
 - Brandon's protocol: **10,000–20,000 steps/day** (averages ~15,000), sometimes on an exercise bike while working
 - Most competitive bodybuilders prep for shows by walking, not running
 - Brandon is currently shredded purely from diet tracking + ~20,000 steps/day — no HIIT

Phase 1: Ideation — Picking Your Business & Price Point [1:35:47](#)

- Brandon has made **\$20M+ online**, mostly before AI tools existed; claims AI changes the calculus dramatically
- Has helped 15,000+ people grow online fitness businesses; students have hit \$500K–\$700K as solo operators
 - Before AI, solo operators typically capped out around \$200K–\$300K before needing to hire
- **Product-based vs. service-based business**
 - Product-based (e.g., supplements): high startup costs, high overhead, easier to fail because businesses fail when they run out of money
 - Service-based: low startup cost, low overhead — his first million came from online training, a service business
 - Recommendation: **start service-based**
- **Figuring out what to sell using AI**
 - If you don't know your niche, open Claude / ChatGPT and use a prompt like:
 - *"I'm thinking of starting a service-based business. Interview me — ask me questions about me and my expertise — and once you have enough information, come up with some business options I can start."*
- **Pricing structure** (using online fitness as the model):
 - The price point determines how you sell it

Package	Price
16-week online training	\$997 (floor, not ceiling)
Monthly (4 weeks)	\$297
Weekly	\$80/week

- For context: in-person training at a nice gym can cost \$100/session × 3x/week = ****\$300/week****
- At ****25 clients × \$80/week × 52 weeks = ~\$104,000/year**** — six figures with just 25 clients

- High-ticket services require sales calls (people rarely click a bio link and spend \$1,000 unprompted)
- Sales call offer hierarchy:
 - Lead offer: \$997 (16-week package)
 - Downsell: \$297/month
 - Final downsell: \$80/week — "everybody's got \$80 a week"
- **Student example — Anna Quinn, Dallas TX**
 - In-person trainer with zero online clients before joining Brandon's program
 - Made **\$80,000 in 8 months** of online coaching ("796" rounded up)
 - 22 years old; her dad told her she'd made more in 4 months than he had

Phase 2: The Testimonial Harvest 1:44:09

- Before chasing paying clients, you need social proof — get testimonials first
- **The process:**
 - Tell everyone you know (family, friends, college/high school contacts, social media followers) you're looking for **at least 5 people** to work with for free
 - Work with them for however long it takes to get a meaningful result (fitness: ~1 month; video editing: a few projects; AI automations: one full setup)
 - In return, you get a testimonial you can use in marketing
 - For fitness: recruit the heaviest people you can find — heavier people lose weight faster, producing more dramatic before/after
 - Brandon once helped someone lose 70 lbs in 70 days
 - After the free period, offer those people a **discounted rate to continue** (e.g., half off) — they beta-tested you and took a chance, so reward them

The testimonial harvest doubles as your first client acquisition — people you helped for free often become your first paying clients because the hardest sale is already done.

- **Why this converts to paid clients easily:**
 - Fitness clients still have a long way to go after one month — they'll want to keep working with you
 - AI automation clients need someone to maintain the systems
 - Video clients always need more content
 - If you did good work, it's an easy upsell
- **Student example — Will**
 - Ran a testimonial harvest; got such strong testimonials that he signed paying clients in his first month
 - Made **\$5,940 in his first 7 days** and **\$32,000+ since August 8th** (his first month)

Phase 3: Marketing — Content Strategy & Niche Hacking 1:51:16

- **You do NOT need to go viral or have a huge following**
 - You only need 25 clients to make six figures
 - There are probably 25 people already following you who'd work with you
 - You don't need 100,000 or even 10,000 followers to hit that number
- **Content posting cadence:**
 - Post **3 times per day** on short-form video platforms: Instagram Reels, YouTube Shorts, TikTok
 - You can post the same video to all three platforms
 - Instagram is where most income will come from, but TikTok and YouTube also generate leads
- **What to post — Option 1: The Viral Content Architect (free tool)**
 - Available via link in description

- Tell it your niche and target market → it generates 20 short-form video ideas with script outlines
- **What to post — Option 2: Niche Hacking**
 - Search your niche in the Instagram/YouTube search bar
 - Look for **10x outliers**: videos that got 10x more views than the creator has subscribers
 - Study why those videos worked, then remake them in your own style (don't copy — reimagine)
 - Analogy: learning guitar by playing other people's songs before writing your own
 - For fitness creators: use the **Viral Content Vault for Online Trainers** (free tool, link in description)
 - Pre-built database of 10x outliers updated daily — hundreds of examples ready to riff on
 - **Student example — Corey Armstrong:**
 - Started with fewer than 1,000 followers using pure niche hacking
 - Grew to **300,000 Instagram followers + ~300,000 YouTube subscribers**
 - Revenue: **\$470,000 in one year** (record year); \$40K in a single month
- **What to post — Option 3: Vid IQ + Claude**
 - Vid IQ is a paid tool that can surface outlier videos; Brandon showed (with some live technical difficulties) how to connect it to Claude to find and analyze outliers programmatically

Automating the Sales Funnel with Go High Level [2:05:31](#)

- **The full funnel flow:**
 - Post content on Instagram/TikTok/YouTube Shorts
 - Include a CTA to **comment a specific word** (e.g., "ripped", "macros", "shred")
 - An automation DMs the commenter a free tool/resource instantly
 - You then start a manual DM conversation using a sales script
 - Book them on a **sales call**
 - Close the sale
 - Target: get **5% of people who receive the free tool** to book a call — that's enough to hit 25 clients
- **What to give away (the free tool):**
 - Avoid generic PDFs — "nobody wants to read your PDF"
 - Build interactive mini web apps inside **Go High Level** (GHL) instead:
 - Example: a macro calculator — user inputs height, weight, age, gender, goal → gets personalized macros instantly
 - Example: a "personalized plan to get ripped" tool
 - Example: a 90-day transformation guide as an interactive experience
 - These look far more professional and deliver instant value vs. a Google Doc
- **Go High Level specifics:**
 - Brandon has used GHL for **8 years** across all his businesses (Victory Unit trading, High Ticket Trainer, etc.)
 - Every email/text he's ever sent came through GHL
 - **30-day free trial** available via link in description — no obligation to continue
 - Key GHL features for this funnel:
 - **Content scheduling:** connect Instagram, YouTube, TikTok → batch-upload content → schedule posting times → goes out automatically
 - **Comment automation:** set trigger word (e.g., someone comments "ripped" on an Instagram post) → GHL auto-DMs them the free tool
 - **CRM & email/SMS:** manage all client communication in one place
 - **White-label option:** you can resell GHL to clients as your own branded platform (relevant for the AI automation business model)
 - You can also automate Instagram comment → DM flows with a simple natural-language prompt inside GHL's AI builder (Brandon demoed this live)

- **The basic funnel summary (where everyone starts):**
 - Post 3x/day
 - Automation: comment word → free tool DM
 - Manual: DM conversation → sales call booking
 - Close → collect payment
- **Student examples at the funnel stage:**
 - Brian: signed 3 clients in one week → **\$18,000 for the month so far**
 - Justin: **\$10,000 in one week**; \$34,000 last month; **\$245,000 for the year**
 - Karen: making **\$200K–\$300K/year** using more advanced GHL email + SMS sequences built on the same foundation

Market Recap with Greg (Trading Segment) 42:29

- Co-host Greg (Victory Trades) joins for a live market analysis discussion
- **Overall market view:**
 - Market has been selling off; Brandon called a neutral-to-bearish stance earlier in the week
 - Pattern observed: choppy mornings, then a breakdown during traders' lunch breaks — trapping buyers and sellers
 - Greg had shorted a "specialist breakout" (false breakout), now mostly out of shorts except transportation (IYT)
 - Looking for **2–3 more down days** then a potential dip-buy opportunity
 - SPY support zone around **750** (currently ~762 at time of recording); Greg sees this as a decent buy zone into year-end if it gets there
- **Key macro factors driving the selloff:**
 - Peace deal rhetoric unwinding: market had rallied ~5% on Trump's war-ending claims; if war continues, that rally gets undone
 - **TLT (bond ETF) selling off** → pressure on stocks; "watch TLT — TLT down, market down"
 - **Dollar weakening** → purchasing power declining; dollar had a big down day recently (showing a bearish flag on the chart)
 - Dollar weakness → **Bitcoin came to life** (Bitcoin denominated in dollars)
- **Asset-specific views:**

Asset	View
Gold (GLD)	Bullish — dollar weakness is tailwind; other countries (esp. China) buying heavily; acts as inflation hedge
Bitcoin	Broke above its range; 9–10% pop in after-hours above 67K; if it pulls back to 67K, could be a dip-buy signal for SPY
Oil	Prices up, adding inflationary pressure
IYT (transports ETF)	Greg is short via puts into September
IWM (small caps)	Greg took off his short; watching support at 294, which may line up with SPY 350
MRNA	Call options went from \$2 to \$8,000 (247,000% gain) in one day after cancer vaccine announcement; large-cap stock up 180% in a day
XBI (biotech ETF)	Strong breakout; Greg likes it as a longer-term play — was at \$100/share when they started discussing it, now at \$163, going for all-time highs (not hit since 2021)
XLV (healthcare ETF)	Making new all-time highs; could be a dip-buy if it sells off a day or two
ServiceNow	Greg's 160 price target; bought the dip at 117 → now up another 10%
Amazon	Short-term weakness possible; long-term bullish on robotics/AI; analyst target ~\$325, Morning Star fair value \$300, currently ~\$260
Netflix	Greg grabbed call options, took 50% profit; thinks Netflix could get above \$100/share by year-end (25% upside from current)

Asset	View
SpaceX	Rejected 150 resistance perfectly; next support at 115; Greg would wait 6 months before buying
RTX	Greg took a loss on calls bought at 223; accepted it and moved on
TSM (TSMC)	Greg's favorite semiconductor; "boring right now — wait until it's 600, 700, 800"
Medtronic (MDT)	Greg holds a decent position; pays a nice dividend
GLDI	Cash-flowing version of GLD; Greg uses this for cash flow from gold exposure
QQQ / QQQM	Recommended for long-term investing; QQQM is half the price of QQQ, same holdings

- **On Anthropic/OpenAI going public:**
 - Both Brandon and Greg skeptical — these companies don't make money; valuations may be unsustainable
 - "That's why I'm using the hell out of it now" — Brandon suggests using AI products aggressively while they're subsidized
 - Preference for ETFs over individual AI stocks for this reason
- **Claude AI for trading (preview of upcoming presentation):**
 - Greg is building a presentation for Victory Trades on using Claude to predict the S&P 500 closing price
 - Yesterday's result: only **5 points off** the closing price
 - Today's result: **40 points off** (market moved due to bond selloff + oil spike after the prediction was made)
 - If accurate, potential to make 100–300% on SPX options nearly every day; wrong = lose 100%
 - Key caveat: timing of the prompt matters — Claude can only see what's happened up to that point
- **Victory Trades Journal (coming soon):**
 - New dashboard showing: win rate, green days, performance trends, P&L, best/worst day, win streaks
 - Calendar view by day, week, month, year; multi-currency support
 - Built-in AI coach that analyzes your trade data and identifies patterns (e.g., "Fridays tend to be red for you")
 - Options page and futures page planned
 - Replaces manual upload to Claude — data will be live and integrated
- **Victory Trades community highlights:**
 - Chris: up **70%+ year-to-date**, making \$200–\$300/day consistently for 2 months on a large account
 - Chase: only trading for **1 month**; making \$500–\$800/day using Greg's Claude strategy + zero DTE call options
 - Simus: cranking out funded account payouts for 3 years straight
 - Dawson: just turned 18, making \$50–\$100/day
 - Victory Trades membership: **\$100/month** — includes trade alerts to phone, live morning sessions, beginner/options/futures courses, Discord community

? Listener Q&A [1:18:26](#)

- **Q: Two intensive sets vs. three — is two sets enough to build muscle?**
 - Think in terms of weekly volume, not per-workout sets
 - Minimum effective dose: **14 sets per muscle group per week**
 - Brandon's target: **21 sets per muscle group per week**
 - Above 21 sets, returns diminish (decreased marginal utility) but don't disappear
 - Aim for 14–21 sets/week per muscle group
- **Q: Setting up Instagram comment automations as a business — good idea? How to find clients?**
 - Great business; very low technical barrier now
 - Built into Go High Level — can white-label GHL and set up automations for clients
 - GHL supports Instagram bots, SMS bots, email bots
 - To find clients: use the same funnel described above — post content, collect leads, book calls

- **Q: I'm stuck at the same weight. Is lifting the only solution to bulk up?**
 - You don't need to get fat to bulk — use **micro cuts and micro bulks**
 - Start by getting lean first (if over 15% body fat, testosterone drops because fat aromatizes free testosterone into estrogen; also less insulin sensitive → body doesn't utilize nutrients well)
 - **Bulking calories:** bodyweight (lbs) × 20
 - **Cutting calories:** bodyweight (lbs) × 10
 - Bulk until bottom abs start getting less defined → immediately switch to cut
 - Cut until ripped → immediately switch back to bulk
 - Never let yourself get fully fat — stay within the band
 - Reason for aggressive targets: FDA allows food labels to be off by **20%**; restaurant portions are unmeasured; a small deficit is too easy to accidentally blow
- **Q: Caffeine or creatine — pick one?**
 - Brandon picks caffeine (but calls it like choosing a favorite child)
 - Has taken **20 grams of creatine daily for almost 30 years**
 - Has taken caffeine even longer